

Chhath Pooja

Seven Speeches for the School Assembly

छठ पूजा

Inside this book

- Six speeches – one for each CEFR level (A1, A2, B1, B2, C1, C2)
- A bonus 7th speech full of phrasal verbs
- CEFR words in **red bold italic**, phrasal verbs in **green bold**
- Vocabulary tables with English and Hindi meanings
- Word count after every speech

Note: CEFR levels of words are assigned by common word lists (Oxford / Cambridge Vocabulary Profile) and can vary slightly between lists.

A1 – Beginner

*Chhath Pooja – A Speech for Beginners (CEFR words highlighted in **red bold italic**)*

Introduction

Good **morning** to our respected Principal, teachers and my dear **friends**. Today I want to talk about Chhath Pooja. It is a big and **happy** festival in India. Many **people** in Bihar, Jharkhand and Uttar Pradesh keep this festival every year. It comes a few days after Diwali, in the month of November.

Body

Chhath Pooja is for the **sun**. People say thank you to the Sun God. The sun gives us light, heat and life. This festival is for four days. On the first day, people have a bath in the **river** and make the house very **clean**. They cook simple **food** with no onion and no garlic. On the second day, they do not eat or drink all day. In the **evening**, they eat sweet rice and roti.

The third day is the biggest day. The whole **family** goes to the river or a pond in the evening. People stand in the **water** and give **fruit**, sugarcane and sweets to the sun. Women wear bright saris and **sing** Chhath songs. It is a beautiful sight. On the fourth day, they go to the river again very early in the morning. They look at the sun as it comes up. Then they end their fast and give prasad to everyone.

I like this festival because everyone helps each other. Children carry the baskets. Mothers and fathers cook and pray. Neighbours come to help clean the road. There is **love** in every house.

Conclusion

Chhath Pooja teaches us to love nature and to say thank you. It teaches us to keep our rivers and our homes clean. Let us all try to do this, dear friends. Thank you for listening to me. Have a happy Chhath Pooja!

Word count: 285 words

A1 Level Words

#	Word	English Meaning	Hindi Meaning (हिंदी अर्थ)
1	morning	the early part of the day	सुबह
2	friend	a person you know well and like	दोस्त / मित्र
3	happy	feeling pleasure or joy	खुश
4	people	men, women and children	लोग
5	sun	the star that gives us light and heat	सूरज
6	river	a large natural stream of water	नदी
7	clean	free from dirt	साफ़ / स्वच्छ
8	food	things that people eat	भोजन / खाना
9	evening	the part of the day before night	शाम
10	family	parents, children and relatives	परिवार
11	water	the clear liquid we drink	पानी / जल
12	fruit	sweet food that grows on trees or plants	फल
13	sing	to make music with your voice	गाना
14	love	a strong feeling of care	प्यार / स्नेह

A2 – Elementary

*Chhath Pooja – A Speech for Elementary Learners (CEFR words highlighted in **red bold italic**)*

Introduction

Good morning, respected Principal, teachers and dear friends. Today I am going to speak about Chhath Pooja, a **wonderful festival** of the Sun God. People **celebrate** it in Bihar, Jharkhand, eastern Uttar Pradesh and Nepal, and now in many cities around the world. It comes six days after Diwali, and it is a very **special** time for millions of families.

Body

Chhath lasts for four days. On the first day, people take a holy bath in a river and **prepare** a simple meal of rice and pumpkin. On the second day, they do not eat until sunset, and then they eat sweet kheer. The third day is the most **important** day. Families walk to a river or a pond and stand in the water at sunset. They offer fruits, sugarcane and sweets to the sun. On the last day, they return before sunrise and pray to the rising sun. Only then do they end their fast of thirty-six hours.

Why do people follow this festival? They **believe** that the sun gives us **energy** and good **health**. Many people also pray for the happiness of their children. In a **village**, you can see the whole neighbourhood working **together**. They clean the roads and the river banks so that everybody can come and pray safely. Women **usually** lead the prayers, but men also take part, and the songs they sing are lovely to hear.

Another good thing about Chhath is that it is very simple. There are no big statues and no loud music. People use bamboo baskets, clay lamps and fresh fruit from the market. Everything is natural, and nothing is wasted.

Conclusion

To finish, Chhath Pooja teaches us to respect nature and to be thankful for what we have. I hope we can all learn from this festival and live in a simple and clean way. Thank you very much for listening.

Word count: 310 words

A2 Level Words

#	Word	English Meaning	Hindi Meaning (हिंदी अर्थ)
1	wonderful	very good; excellent	अद्भुत / शानदार
2	festival	a special day or period of celebration	त्योहार / उत्सव
3	celebrate	to do something special for a happy event	जश्न मनाना / मनाना
4	special	better or different from usual	खास / विशेष
5	prepare	to make something ready	तैयार करना
6	important	having great value or meaning	महत्वपूर्ण
7	believe	to think something is true	विश्वास करना
8	energy	the power to be active	ऊर्जा / शक्ति
9	health	the condition of your body	स्वास्थ्य / सेहत
10	village	a very small town in the countryside	गाँव
11	together	with each other	साथ मिलकर
12	usually	in most cases; normally	आमतौर पर

B1 – Intermediate

*Chhath Pooja – A Speech for Intermediate Learners (CEFR words highlighted in **red bold italic**)*

Introduction

Good morning to our respected Principal, honourable teachers and my dear friends. Today I would like to talk about Chhath Pooja, an ancient **religious** festival dedicated to the Sun God and Chhathi Maiya. It is celebrated mainly in Bihar, Jharkhand and eastern Uttar Pradesh, but Indians living abroad also follow this **tradition** with great joy. It is a beautiful part of our **culture**.

Body

The festival continues for four days, and each day has its own meaning. It begins with Nahay Khay, when devotees bathe in a river and eat a pure meal. The next day, called Kharna, they fast all day and break the fast in the evening with sweet kheer. The third day is Sandhya Arghya, when whole families **gather** at the riverbank at sunset to offer fruits and thekua to the setting sun. On the final morning, they offer prayers to the rising sun. Devotees **pray** for the health and happiness of their children.

What impresses me most is the **strength** and self-control of the people who fast for thirty-six hours without even drinking water. Chhath also brings the whole **community** together. Rich and poor stand side by side in the same water, and nobody needs a priest to perform the prayers. This shows **respect** for equality.

Furthermore, people take care of the **environment** during this festival by cleaning the ghats and using natural things like bamboo baskets and clay lamps. Older people pass their **beliefs** on to the next **generation**, and young people feel **thankful** for their family's love and sacrifice.

Conclusion

In conclusion, Chhath Pooja is more than a festival; it is a lesson about gratitude, discipline and living in harmony with nature. Let us promise to keep our rivers clean and to respect every tradition that teaches us to be better human beings. Thank you for your kind attention.

Word count: 303 words

B1 Level Words

#	Word	English Meaning	Hindi Meaning (हिंदी अर्थ)
1	religious	connected with faith and worship	धार्मिक
2	tradition	a custom passed down over time	परंपरा
3	culture	the way of life of a group of people	संस्कृति
4	gather	to come together in one place	इकट्ठा होना
5	pray	to speak to God	प्रार्थना करना
6	strength	the quality of being strong	शक्ति / ताकत
7	community	people living in the same area or sharing interests	समुदाय / समाज
8	respect	a feeling of admiration for someone	सम्मान / आदर
9	environment	the natural world around us	पर्यावरण
10	belief	a strong feeling that something is true	मान्यता / आस्था
11	generation	all people born around the same time	पीढ़ी
12	thankful	feeling grateful	आभारी / कृतज्ञ

B2 – Upper-Intermediate

*Chhath Pooja – A Speech for Upper-Intermediate Learners (CEFR words highlighted in **red bold italic**)*

Introduction

Good morning, respected Principal, esteemed teachers and my dear friends. It gives me immense pleasure to speak about Chhath Pooja, a festival that beautifully blends **devotion**, **discipline** and love for nature. Every year, after Diwali, the banks of rivers from Patna to Mumbai fill with people who come to thank the Sun God, the source of all life on Earth.

Body

The **significance** of Chhath lies in its simplicity. Unlike many festivals, it has no idols and no elaborate temples. Devotees stand in water and present **offerings** of bananas, sugarcane, coconuts and homemade sweets to the sun. This reflects an **ancient** understanding that nature itself deserves our worship. Many scholars **observe** that the festival probably dates back thousands of years, and traditional texts even mention sun worship in a similar form.

Moreover, the four-day fast is a real **sacrifice**. Men and women spend thirty-six hours without a drop of water, and this hardship **symbolizes** the purification of the body and the mind. I would like to **emphasize** that no one forces them; they do it out of faith and gratitude.

Chhath is also a living **heritage**. Recipes, folk songs and customs have been handed down from grandmothers to granddaughters for generations. Another **principle** worth admiring is equality: rich and poor, young and old, stand shoulder to shoulder in the same river. In an age of noise and consumption, such a quiet and clean celebration is a valuable example for all of us.

Conclusion

To sum up, Chhath Pooja shows that faith and responsibility can walk together. If we protect our rivers and respect our elders, we honour both our culture and our future. Thank you for listening so patiently.

Word count: 277 words

B2 Level Words

#	Word	English Meaning	Hindi Meaning (हिंदी अर्थ)
1	devotion	deep love and loyalty to God	भक्ति / श्रद्धा
2	discipline	controlled and orderly behaviour	अनुशासन
3	significance	importance or special meaning	महत्व / तात्पर्य
4	offering	something given to God as a gift	अर्पण / चढ़ावा
5	ancient	from very long ago	प्राचीन
6	observe	to follow a rule or custom; to notice	पालन करना ; गौर करना
7	sacrifice	giving up something valuable for a purpose	त्याग / बलिदान
8	symbolize	to represent an idea	प्रतीक होना / दर्शाना
9	emphasize	to give special importance to something	ज़ोर देना
10	heritage	traditions passed from past generations	विरासत
11	principle	a basic rule or belief	सिद्धांत

C1 – Advanced

*Chhath Pooja – A Speech for Advanced Learners (CEFR words highlighted in **red bold italic**)*

Introduction

Good morning, respected Principal, distinguished faculty and my dear friends. Standing before you today, I feel privileged to speak about Chhath Pooja, a festival that **embodies** the deepest bond between humanity and the natural world. Rooted in eastern India, yet now celebrated across continents, it is a **profound** act of thanksgiving to the Sun.

Body

At its heart lies a series of **rituals** that demand extraordinary **resilience**. Devotees observe a waterless fast lasting thirty-six hours, then stand waist-deep in a river at dusk and again at dawn, offering **worship** to the setting and the rising sun. Such **fervent** devotion is remarkable in a modern world that rarely asks for patience. The emphasis on **purity** is equally striking: food is cooked without onion or garlic, on clay stoves, and every utensil is scrubbed until it shines.

What I find most compelling, however, is the festival's **ecological** wisdom. The offerings, namely bamboo baskets, earthen lamps and seasonal fruit, leave almost no waste, making Chhath a model of **sustainable** celebration at a time when plastic pollution chokes our rivers.

Moreover, the festival strengthens social **cohesion**. Strangers volunteer to clean the ghats, distribute water and guide the crowds, and differences of caste, wealth and status seem to dissolve at the water's edge. This deep **reverence** for the elements reminds us that we are guests on this planet, not its owners.

Conclusion

In conclusion, Chhath Pooja is not merely a religious observance; it is a living philosophy of restraint, gratitude and shared responsibility. Let us carry its message beyond the riverbank and into our daily choices, so that the rivers we honour today remain clean for the generations that follow. Thank you for your attention.

Word count: 278 words

C1 Level Words

#	Word	English Meaning	Hindi Meaning (हिंदी अर्थ)
1	embody	to be a perfect example of an idea	साकार करना / मूर्त रूप देना
2	profound	very deep; intense	गहरा / गंभीर
3	ritual	a fixed ceremony or set of actions	अनुष्ठान / कर्मकांड
4	resilience	the ability to recover from difficulty	सहनशक्ति / लचीलापन
5	worship	showing respect and love to God	पूजा / आराधना
6	fervent	showing strong and sincere feeling	उत्कट / उत्साही
7	purity	the state of being clean and free of impurity	पवित्रता / शुद्धता
8	ecological	related to nature and living things	पारिस्थितिक / पर्यावरण-संबंधी
9	sustainable	able to continue without harming nature	टिकाऊ / सतत
10	cohesion	the state of being united	एकजुटता / सामंजस्य
11	reverence	deep respect	श्रद्धा / पूज्य भाव

C2 – Proficiency

*Chhath Pooja – A Speech for Proficient Learners (CEFR words highlighted in **red bold italic**)*

Introduction

Respected Principal, distinguished teachers and my dear friends, good morning. It is an honour to address you on Chhath Pooja, arguably the most **quintessential** expression of India's ancient dialogue with nature. Every November, millions of people, from farmers to bankers, converge on rivers, ponds and reservoirs to **venerate** the Sun, the visible source of all life.

Body

What distinguishes Chhath from most other festivals is its uncompromising **austerity**. There are no idols, no lavish decorations and no priestly intermediaries. Devotees fast for thirty-six hours without water and stand submerged at twilight, sustained by **unwavering** faith. Such discipline seems almost to **transcend** ordinary human endurance, yet it is undertaken quietly, without spectacle or complaint.

The **ethos** of the festival is unmistakably **egalitarian**: the landlord and the labourer immerse themselves in the same water, offer the same humble produce and receive the same golden light. Its liturgy is **inextricably** bound to the agricultural rhythm of the harvest, and it rests upon a spirit of **reciprocity**: we receive warmth and nourishment from the Sun, and in return we offer thanks, humility and a scrupulously clean riverbank.

Furthermore, the **myriad** folk songs of Chhath, sung in Bhojpuri, Maithili and Magahi, carry the memory of entire communities, and the **sanctity** accorded to water reminds us that ecological reverence is neither a modern fashion nor a foreign import. In this sense, the festival may **exemplify** a form of environmental ethics that our age is only beginning to rediscover.

Conclusion

Let me conclude, then, by suggesting that Chhath Pooja is a lesson as much as a ceremony: that true devotion is measured not by grandeur but by sincerity, and that a society which honours its rivers honours itself. Thank you, most sincerely, for your patient attention.

Word count: 287 words

C2 Level Words

#	Word	English Meaning	Hindi Meaning (हिंदी अर्थ)
1	quintessential	the most perfect example of something	सर्वोत्कृष्ट / आदर्श उदाहरण
2	venerate	to honour with great respect	पूज्य मानकर सम्मान देना
3	austerity	a strict, simple way of living	कठोर संयम / तपस्या
4	unwavering	steady and never changing	अटल / अडिग
5	transcend	to go beyond the normal limits	से परे जाना / अतिक्रमण करना
6	ethos	the guiding beliefs of a group	मूल भाव / लोकाचार
7	egalitarian	believing everyone is equal	समतावादी
8	inextricably	in a way that cannot be separated	अटूट रूप से / अविभाज्य रूप से
9	reciprocity	mutual give-and-take	पारस्परिकता / आदान-प्रदान
10	myriad	a very large number of	असंख्य
11	sanctity	holiness; sacred quality	पावनता / पवित्रता
12	exemplify	to be a typical example of	उदाहरण प्रस्तुत करना

Bonus Version – Phrasal Verbs

*Chhath Pooja – A Speech Packed with Phrasal Verbs (phrasal verbs highlighted in **green bold**)*

Introduction

Good morning, respected Principal, teachers and my dear friends. I am really **looking forward to** speaking with you today about Chhath Pooja. Every year, as soon as Diwali **wraps up**, families in Bihar and Jharkhand **gear up** for four days of devotion, and I would like to **walk you through** what happens.

Body

The celebrations **kick off** with Nahay Khay. Devotees **get up** at dawn, **clean up** the house and **head out** to the river for a holy bath. On the second day, they **carry on** fasting until sunset, and then they **tuck into** sweet kheer. Neighbours **drop by** to share the prasad, and everyone **pitches in** to help.

The third day is the highlight. Families **set off** for the ghats in the afternoon, **bringing along** baskets of fruit, sugarcane and thekua. As the sun starts to **go down**, people **step into** the water and **hold up** their offerings towards the sky, and the whole riverbank **lights up** with hundreds of lamps.

It is not easy to **go without** water for thirty-six hours, but devotees never **give up**. Elders **look after** the children, young people **take over** the cooking, and the whole family **comes together to carry out** each ritual. These customs are **passed down** from one generation to the next, and nobody **backs out** or **holds back**.

Volunteers **turn up** at the riverbank to **clean up** the ghats, **hand out** drinking water and **help out** the elderly. Many of us **look up to** these devotees, who truly **stand for** discipline and faith.

Conclusion

To **sum up**, Chhath Pooja **brings about** unity, humility and respect for nature. Let us **make up** our minds today to **keep up** this tradition, **take care of** our rivers and never **let nature down**. Thank you for **putting up with** my long speech!

Word count: 296 words

Phrasal Verbs used in this speech

#	Word	English Meaning	Hindi Meaning (हिंदी अर्थ)
1	look forward to	to wait for something with pleasure	उत्सुकता से प्रतीक्षा करना
2	wrap up	to finish; to end	समाप्त करना / निपटाना
3	gear up	to get ready for something	तैयारी करना / कमर कसना
4	walk (someone) through	to explain step by step	चरण-दर-चरण समझाना
5	kick off	to begin	शुरुआत करना
6	get up	to rise from bed	उठना
7	clean up	to make a place tidy	साफ़-सफ़ाई करना
8	head out	to leave for a place	(किसी जगह के लिए) निकलना
9	carry on	to continue	जारी रखना
10	tuck into	to eat with enjoyment	मज़े से खाना
11	drop by	to visit briefly	अचानक/थोड़ी देर के लिए मिलने आना
12	pitch in	to help with a task	मदद में जुट जाना / हाथ बँटाना
13	set off	to start a journey	यात्रा पर निकलना
14	bring along	to take with you	साथ लाना
15	go down	(the sun) to set	(सूरज का) डूबना
16	step into	to enter	भीतर कदम रखना / प्रवेश करना
17	hold up	to raise	ऊपर उठाना
18	light up	to fill with light	रोशन होना / जगमगाना
19	go without	to manage without something	बिना रहना
20	give up	to stop trying	हार मान लेना / छोड़ देना
21	look after	to take care of	देखभाल करना
22	take over	to take control from someone	कार्यभार सँभालना
23	come together	to unite	एकजुट होना / इकट्ठा होना
24	carry out	to perform; to complete	पूरा करना / अंजाम देना
25	pass down	to hand on to the next generation	पीढ़ी-दर-पीढ़ी सौंपना
26	back out	to withdraw from a promise	पीछे हट जाना
27	hold back	to hesitate or restrain oneself	रुकना / झिझकना
28	turn up	to arrive; to appear	आ पहुँचना / हाज़िर होना
29	hand out	to give to many people	बाँटना
30	help out	to assist	सहायता करना

31	look up to	to admire	सम्मान करना / आदर्श मानना
32	stand for	to represent	का प्रतीक होना
33	sum up	to summarise	सारांश देना
34	bring about	to cause to happen	(परिवर्तन) लाना
35	make up (one's) mind	to decide	निश्चय करना
36	keep up	to continue at the same level	बनाए रखना
37	take care of	to look after	ध्यान रखना / संभालना
38	let down	to disappoint	निराश करना / धोखा देना
39	put up with	to tolerate	सहन करना

Word Count Summary

Version	Words in speech	Words listed in table
A1 – Beginner	285	14
A2 – Elementary	310	12
B1 – Intermediate	303	12
B2 – Upper-Intermediate	277	11
C1 – Advanced	278	11
C2 – Proficiency	287	12
Bonus Version – Phrasal Verbs	296	39

Word counts include the greeting and closing lines of each speech; headings are not counted.